



Matrix Infection

You are given a matrix where each cell is either:

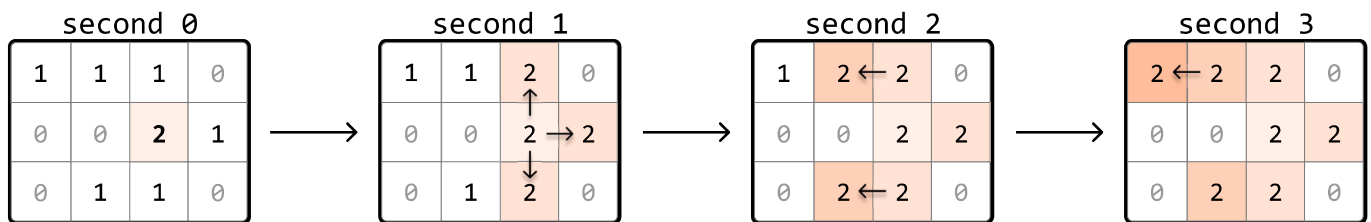
0: Empty

1: Uninfected

2: Infected

With each passing second, every infected cell (2) infects its uninfected neighboring cells (1) that are 4-directionally adjacent. Determine the number of seconds required for all uninfected cells to become infected. If this is impossible, return -1.

Example:



Input: matrix = [[1, 1, 1, 0], [0, 0, 2, 1], [0, 1, 1, 0]]

Output: 3

Intuition

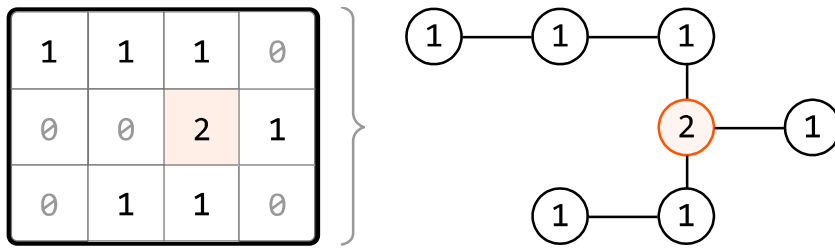
Let's begin tackling this problem by considering a simple case where the initial matrix contains only one infected cell.

Matrix with one infected cell

Consider the following matrix, containing just one 2:

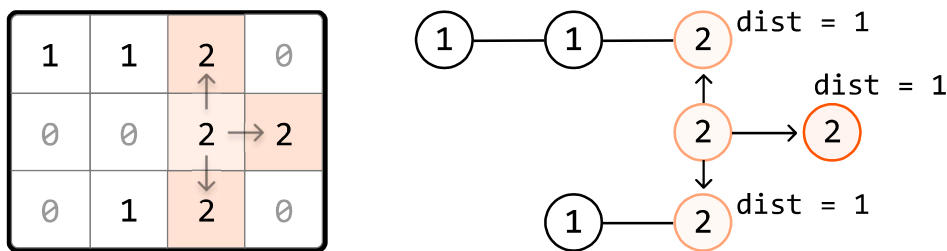
1	1	1	0
0	0	2	1
0	1	1	0

cells as a connected graph:

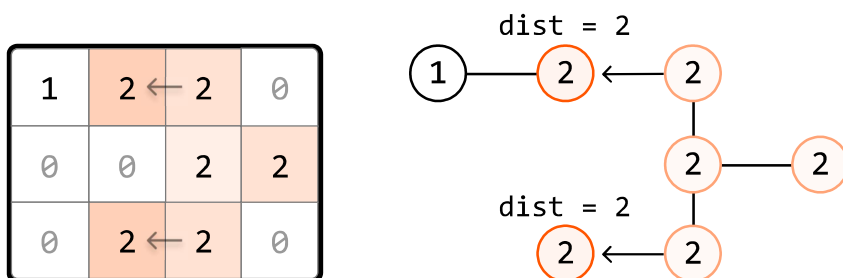


This helps us think about this problem as a graph traversal problem. Which traversal algorithm will allow us to simulate the infection process? To find out, let's observe how cells get infected each second.

After the first second, the adjacent uninfected neighbors of the first infected cell become infected. These cells are a distance of 1 away from the initially infected cell:



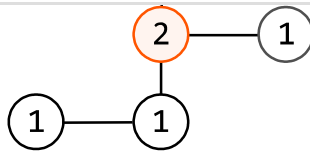
One second later, the neighbors of the most recently infected cells get infected. These cells are a distance of 2 from the initial infected cell:



As we can see, the outward expansion from the initially infected cell is similar to how level-order traversal works in a tree, where each level represents nodes that are at a specific distance from the initially infected node.

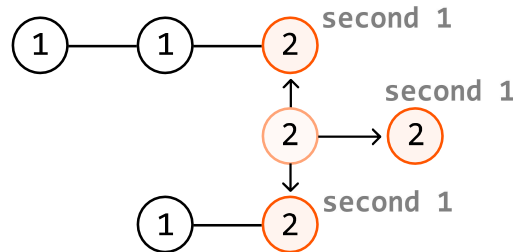
So, let's perform a level-order traversal to infect cells, starting at the infected cell. **Each level that gets traversed corresponds to 1-second passing in the infection process.**

0	0	2	1
0	1	1	0



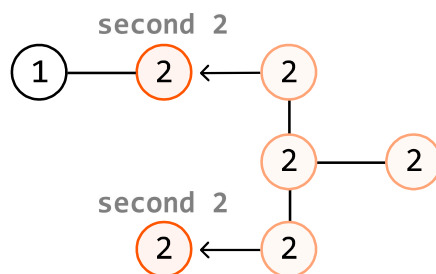
second 1

1	1	2	0
0	0	2	2
0	1	2	0



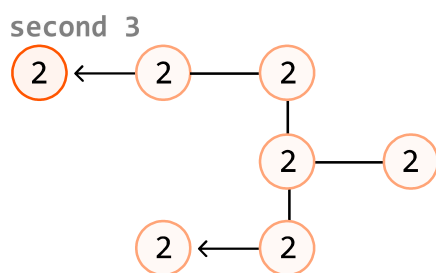
second 2

1	2	2	0
0	0	2	2
0	2	2	0



second 3

2	2	2	0
0	0	2	2
0	2	2	0



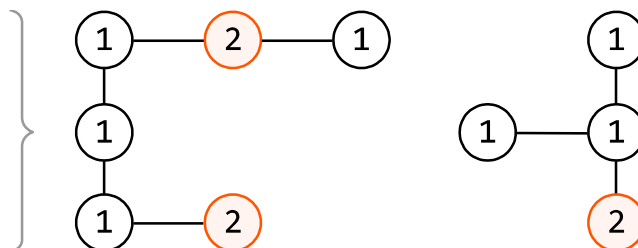
Regarding the implementation of this traversal, we know that level-order traversal is a modified version of BFS. So, we use a queue to implement this traversal. If you're unfamiliar with how this works, review the *Rightmost Nodes of a Binary Tree* problem from the *Tree* chapter, which implements a level-order traversal on a binary tree.

Now, let's consider how we would handle a matrix which initially contains multiple infected cells.

Matrix with multiple infected cells

Consider the following example and its corresponding graph visualization:

1	2	1	0	1
1	0	0	1	1
1	2	0	0	2



In this example, multiple cells are initially infected, meaning there are multiple cells at level 0 of the traversal.

way, the traversal starts with all initially infected cells as level 0, allowing the infection process to begin simultaneously from multiple starting points:

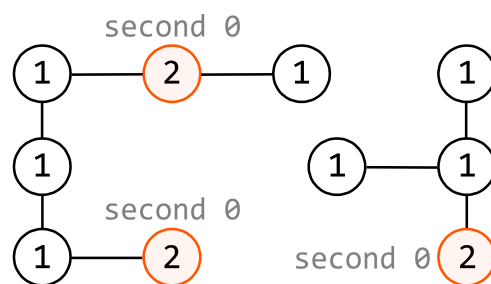
	0	1	2	3	4
0	1	2	1	0	1
1	1	0	0	1	1
2	1	2	0	0	2

queue = [(0, 1) (2, 1) (2, 4)]

When we start with multiple cells in the queue, we can see what the level order process looks like:

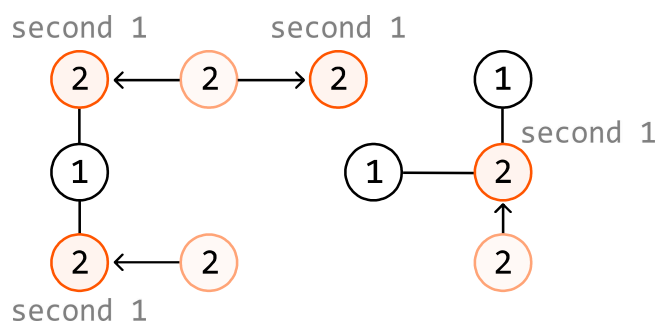
second 0

1	2	1	0	1
1	0	0	1	1
1	2	0	0	2



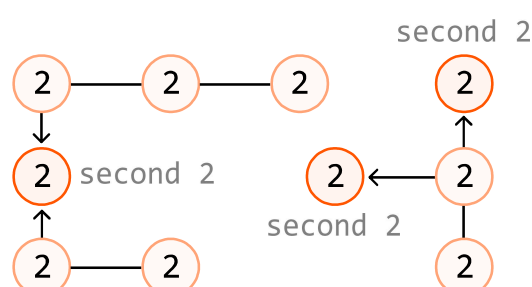
second 1

2	2	2	0	1
1	0	0	1	2
2	2	0	0	2



second 2

2	2	2	0	2
2	0	0	2	2
2	2	0	0	2



Unreachable uninfected cells

It's important to keep in mind that it's not always possible to infect all uninfected cells. We could encounter situations where it's impossible to reach an uninfected cell, such as in the following example:

this will never be infected →

1	2	1
0	0	0
1	0	0

the level 0 infected cells, we can also count how many 1s there are:

	0	1	2
0	1	2	1
1	0	0	0
2	1	0	0

queue = [(0, 1)]
ones = 3

Then, as we perform the level-order traversal, we can decrement this count for each uninfected cell we infect. This way, the value of this count after the traversal will represent the number of cells that remained uninfected. We return -1 if this count is greater than 0:

	0	1	2
0	2 ← 2 → 2		
1	0	0	0
2	1	0	0

ones = 1 > 0
→ return -1

Implementation

Python

JavaScript

Java

```

from typing import List
from collections import deque

def matrix_infection(matrix: List[List[int]]) → int:
    dirs = [(-1, 0), (1, 0), (0, -1), (0, 1)]
    queue = deque()
    ones = seconds = 0
    # Count the total number of uninfected cells and add each infected cell to the
    # queue to represent level 0 of the level-order traversal.
    for r in range(len(matrix)):
        for c in range(len(matrix[0])):
            if matrix[r][c] == 1:
                ones += 1
            elif matrix[r][c] == 2:
                queue.append((r, c))
    # Use level-order traversal to determine how long it takes to infect the
    # uninfected cells.
    while queue and ones > 0:
        # 1 second passes with each level of the matrix that's explored.

```

```
# Infect any neighboring 1s and add them to the queue to be processed
# the next level.
for d in dirs:
    next_r, next_c = r + d[0], c + d[1]
    if is_within_bounds(next_r, next_c, matrix) and matrix[next_r][next_c] == 1:
        matrix[next_r][next_c] = 2
        ones -= 1
        queue.append((next_r, next_c))
# If there are still uninfected cells left, return -1. Otherwise, return the time
# passed.
return seconds if ones == 0 else -1

def is_within_bounds(r: int, c: int, matrix: List[List[int]]) → bool:
    return 0 ≤ r < len(matrix) and 0 ≤ c < len(matrix[0])
```

Complexity Analysis

Time complexity: The time complexity of `matrix_infection` is $O(m \cdot n)$, where m denotes the number of rows, and n denotes the number of columns. This is because in the worst case, every cell in the matrix is explored during level-order traversal.

Space complexity: The space complexity is $O(m \cdot n)$, primarily due to the queue, which can store up to $m \cdot n$ cells.

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